

to people who tend to bring a bottle when they come over.

6. Shopping frugally can lead to cultural adventures

I used to live in China, and oh did we eat cheap over there. Now, I can't figure out how to make biweekly shopping flights to Beijing work out economically, but I have found that exploring neighborhoods dominated by immigrants can be both money-saving and fun.

The budget has pushed me to walk a little farther out of my neighborhood and check out the grocery store closer to a Hispanic community, where there is always fresh chorizo and menudo on display. I love this store! One of the things I love is that instead of putting soon-to-expire foods in the dumpster for the freegans, Fair Share Foods just puts them on a fire sale. My kids love individual containers of yogurt, and I can usually get them at this store, with a coupon, for 25 cents or less. They'll expire in a couple of days, but they'll be gone by then, and anyway, yogurt lasts awhile past the date.

The only thing I don't like about this store is that the shopping carts don't have seat belts, so I usually go with the stroller. But despite the fact that most of the other shoppers do

not look or sound like me, I always feel comfortable and welcome there. So explore a little and, who knows, you might get to try some fun new foods too. In our old city, we also used to hit such a grocery store and our daughter would have a good time riding the 25-cent merry-go-round with little Spanish-speaking friends. In toddlerese, it's all the same language, right?

Similarly, if you live in a city with a Chinatown, you will find produce markets with better prices and fresher goods than the supermarket.

7. Yes, we will eat all that cereal

When I stocked up on a dozen boxes or more of on-sale cereal, friends always laugh and ask how on earth we will eat it all. C'mon! Cereal lasts forever, has a million uses (especially in a house with little kids), and is normally kind of expensive. Every once in awhile, a store will have a great sale event where it goes for around \$1 a box. When that happens, I'm yelling, "Buy, buy, buy!" I will go in with all the coupons I've been hoarding for weeks and I have never bought too much. After all, you can always donate any excess to the local food bank.